

VxLEARN Networks

Networking & Cybersecurity Track
Simulated Employment Program

Lab Report: Windows Task Manager

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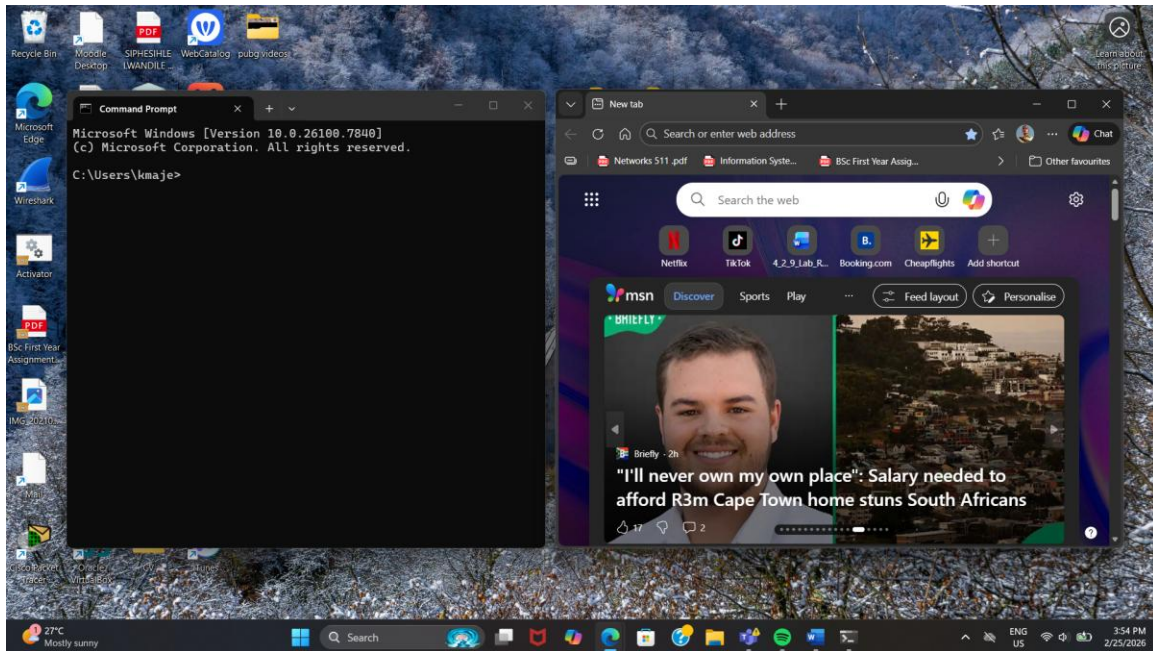
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1. Introduction

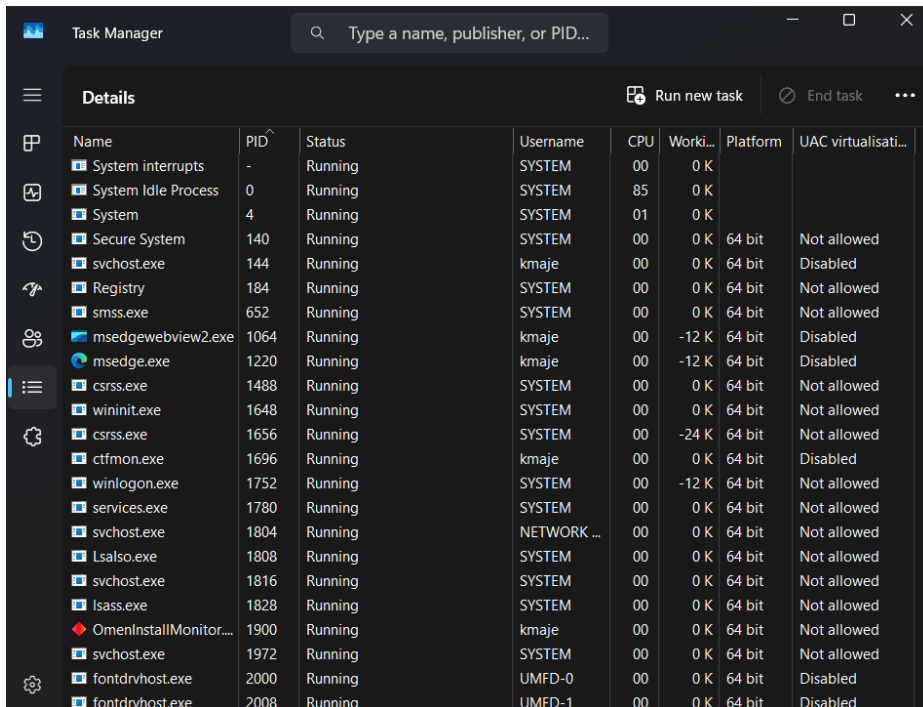
In this lab, I explored the Windows Task Manager to understand how it monitors system performance, manages processes, and displays running services. Task Manager is an essential administrative and security tool because it allows monitoring of applications, background processes, and system resources.

2. Part 1 – Working in the Processes Tab

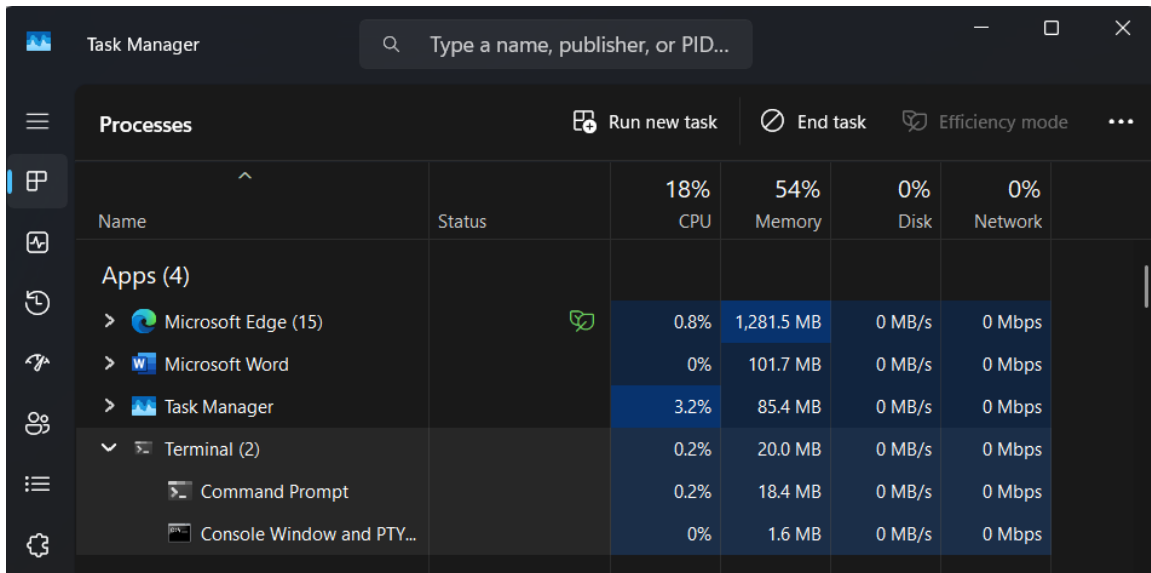
Step 1: Open Command Prompt and Web Browser.



Step 2: Open Task Manager and click More Details.



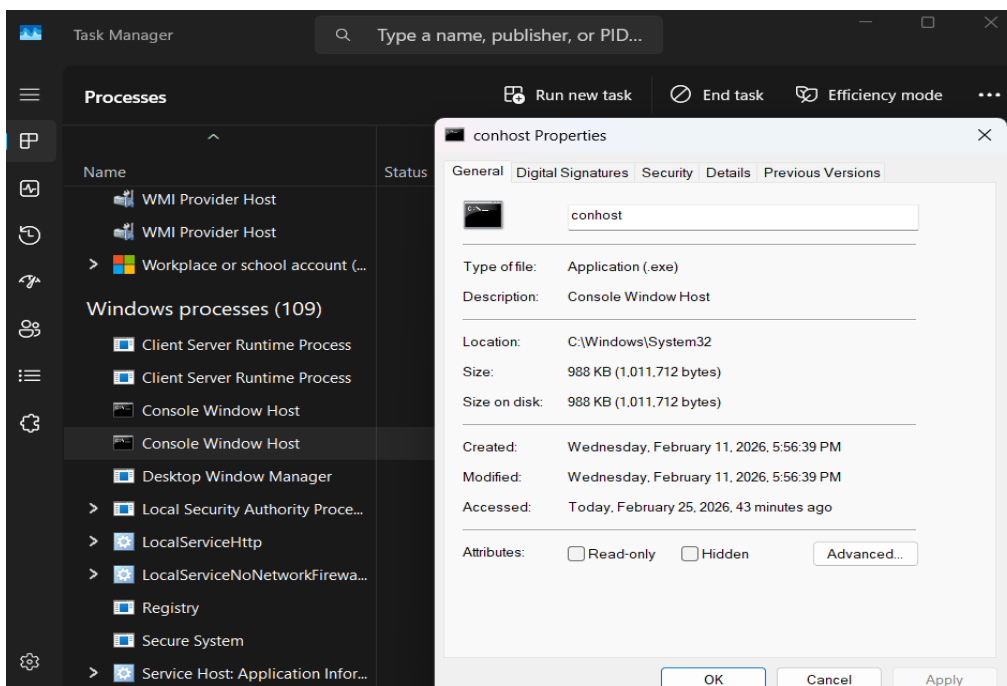
Step 3: Expand Windows Command Processor.



Under this heading, Console Window Host (conhost.exe) was displayed. This process supports the command-line interface.

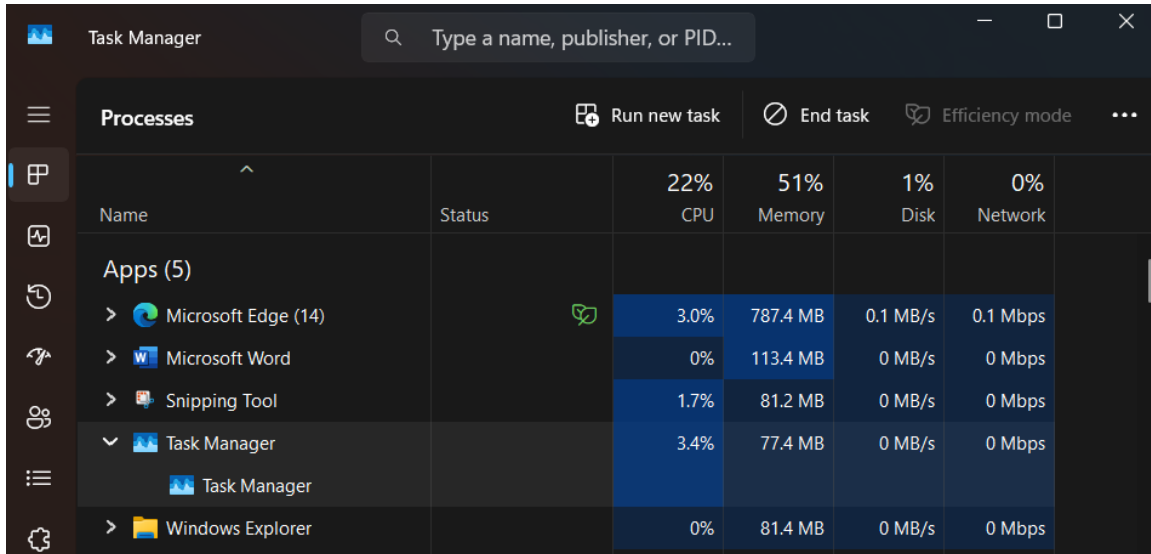
Step 4: View Properties of Console Window Host.

The file location was C:\Windows\System32\conhost.exe, confirming it is a legitimate Windows process.



Step 5: Close Command Prompt.

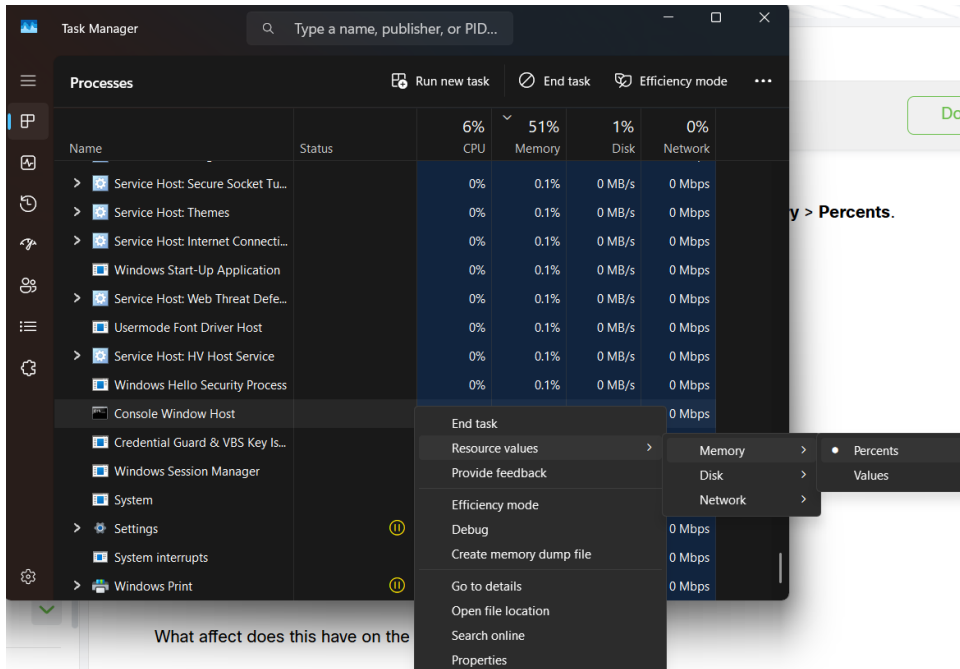
When closed, both Windows Command Processor and Console Window Host disappeared from Task Manager.



The screenshot shows the Windows Task Manager window with the 'Processes' tab selected. The window title is 'Task Manager' and it has a search bar that says 'Type a name, publisher, or PID...'. The 'Processes' tab is active, and there are buttons for 'Run new task', 'End task', and 'Efficiency mode'. The table of processes is as follows:

Name	Status	CPU	Memory	Disk	Network
Apps (5)					
> Microsoft Edge (14)		3.0%	787.4 MB	0.1 MB/s	0.1 Mbps
> Microsoft Word		0%	113.4 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
> Snipping Tool		1.7%	81.2 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
Task Manager		3.4%	77.4 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
Task Manager					
> Windows Explorer		0%	81.4 MB	0 MB/s	0 Mbps

Step 6: Sort by Memory and Change to Percentage View.



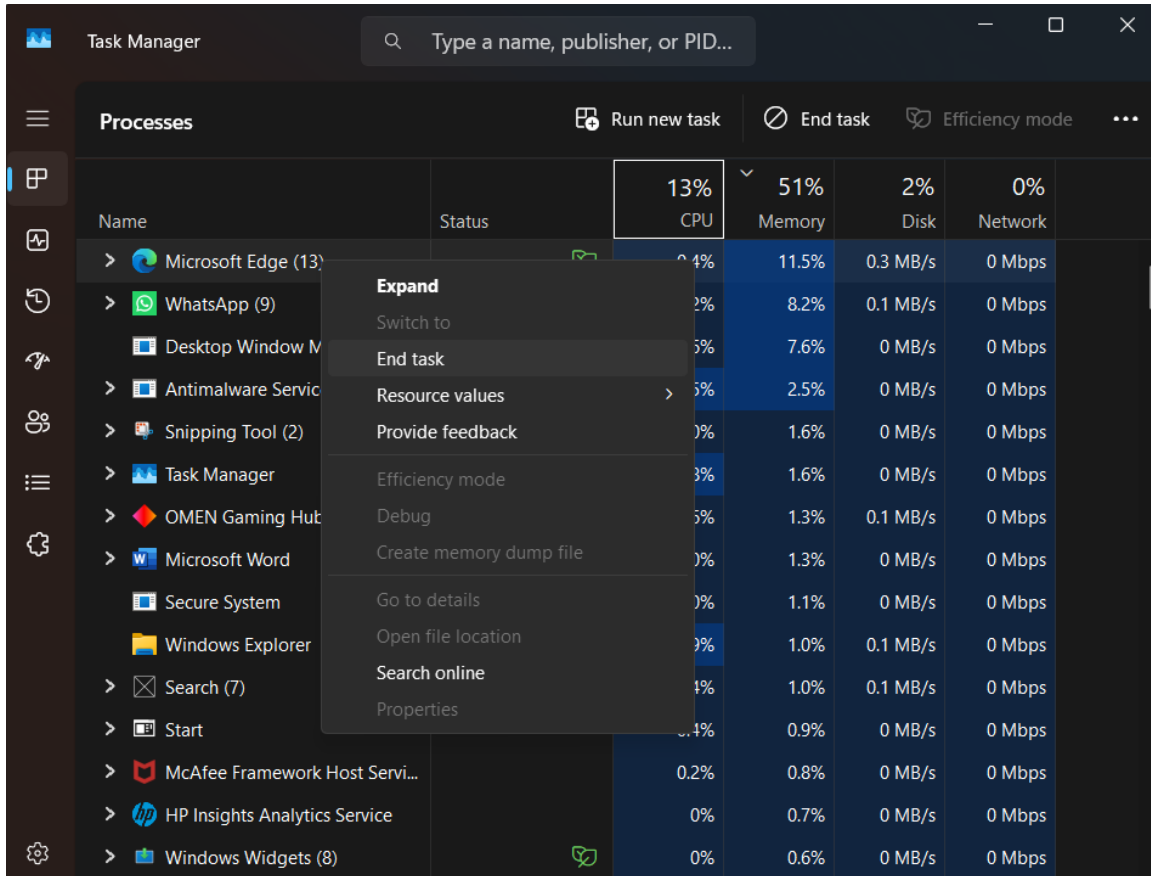
The screenshot shows the Windows Task Manager window with the 'Processes' tab selected. The window title is 'Task Manager' and it has a search bar that says 'Type a name, publisher, or PID...'. The 'Processes' tab is active, and there are buttons for 'Run new task', 'End task', and 'Efficiency mode'. The table of processes is as follows:

Name	Status	CPU	Memory	Disk	Network
> Service Host: Secure Socket Tu...		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
> Service Host: Themes		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
> Service Host: Internet Connecti...		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
Windows Start-Up Application		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
> Service Host: Web Threat Defe...		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
Usermode Font Driver Host		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
> Service Host: HV Host Service		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
Windows Hello Security Process		0%	0.1%	0 MB/s	0 Mbps
Console Window Host					
Credential Guard & VBS Key Is...					
Windows Session Manager					
System					
> Settings					
System interrupts					
> Windows Print					

A context menu is open over the 'Memory' column header, showing options: 'End task', 'Resource values', 'Provide feedback', 'Efficiency mode', 'Debug', 'Create memory dump file', 'Go to details', 'Open file location', 'Search online', and 'Properties'. The 'Resource values' option is expanded, showing a sub-menu with 'Memory', 'Disk', and 'Network'. The 'Memory' option is selected, and a further sub-menu is open showing 'Percents' (selected) and 'Values'.

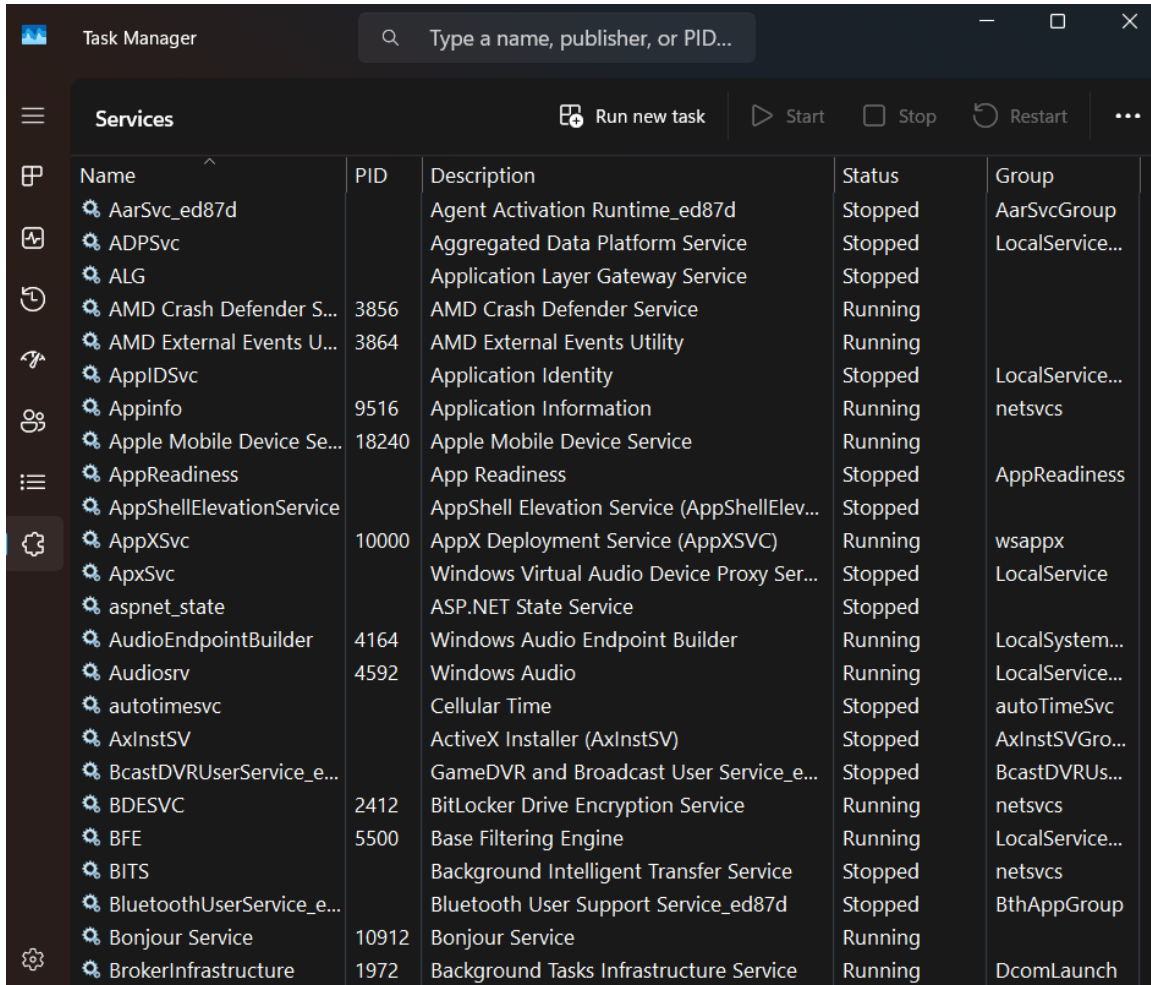
Step 7: End Microsoft Edge Task.

Ending the Microsoft Edge task immediately closed all browser windows.



3. Part 2 – Working in the Services Tab

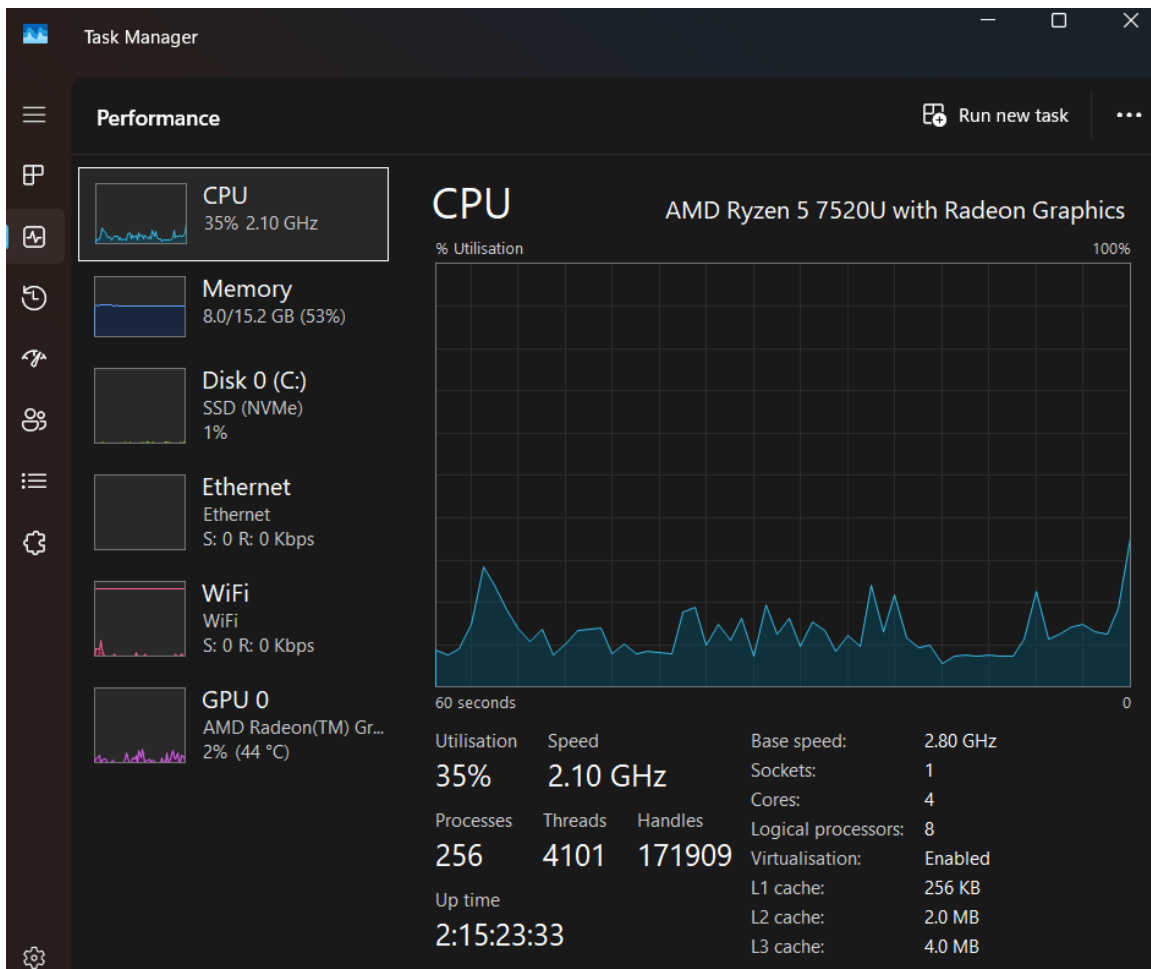
In the Services tab, I observed services with statuses such as Running and Stopped.

The image is a screenshot of the Windows Task Manager application, specifically the 'Services' tab. The window title is 'Task Manager'. At the top, there is a search bar with the placeholder text 'Type a name, publisher, or PID...'. Below the search bar, the 'Services' tab is selected, and there are buttons for 'Run new task', 'Start', 'Stop', 'Restart', and a menu icon. The main area displays a list of services with columns for Name, PID, Description, Status, and Group. The services are listed in alphabetical order by name. The status of each service is indicated by a green dot (Running) or a red dot (Stopped). The group of each service is listed in the 'Group' column.

Name	PID	Description	Status	Group
AarSvc_ed87d		Agent Activation Runtime_ed87d	Stopped	AarSvcGroup
ADPSvc		Aggregated Data Platform Service	Stopped	LocalService...
ALG		Application Layer Gateway Service	Stopped	
AMD Crash Defender S...	3856	AMD Crash Defender Service	Running	
AMD External Events U...	3864	AMD External Events Utility	Running	
AppIDSvc		Application Identity	Stopped	LocalService...
Appinfo	9516	Application Information	Running	netsvcs
Apple Mobile Device Se...	18240	Apple Mobile Device Service	Running	
AppReadiness		App Readiness	Stopped	AppReadiness
AppShellElevationService		AppShell Elevation Service (AppShellElev...	Stopped	
AppXSvc	10000	AppX Deployment Service (AppXSVC)	Running	wsappx
ApxSvc		Windows Virtual Audio Device Proxy Ser...	Stopped	LocalService
aspnet_state		ASP.NET State Service	Stopped	
AudioEndpointBuilder	4164	Windows Audio Endpoint Builder	Running	LocalSystem...
Audiosrv	4592	Windows Audio	Running	LocalService...
autotimesvc		Cellular Time	Stopped	autoTimeSvc
AxInstSV		ActiveX Installer (AxInstSV)	Stopped	AxInstSVGro...
BcastDVRUserService_e...		GameDVR and Broadcast User Service_e...	Stopped	BcastDVRUs...
BDESVC	2412	BitLocker Drive Encryption Service	Running	netsvcs
BFE	5500	Base Filtering Engine	Running	LocalService...
BITS		Background Intelligent Transfer Service	Stopped	netsvcs
BluetoothUserService_e...		Bluetooth User Support Service_ed87d	Stopped	BthAppGroup
Bonjour Service	10912	Bonjour Service	Running	
BrokerInfrastructure	1972	Background Tasks Infrastructure Service	Running	DcomLaunch

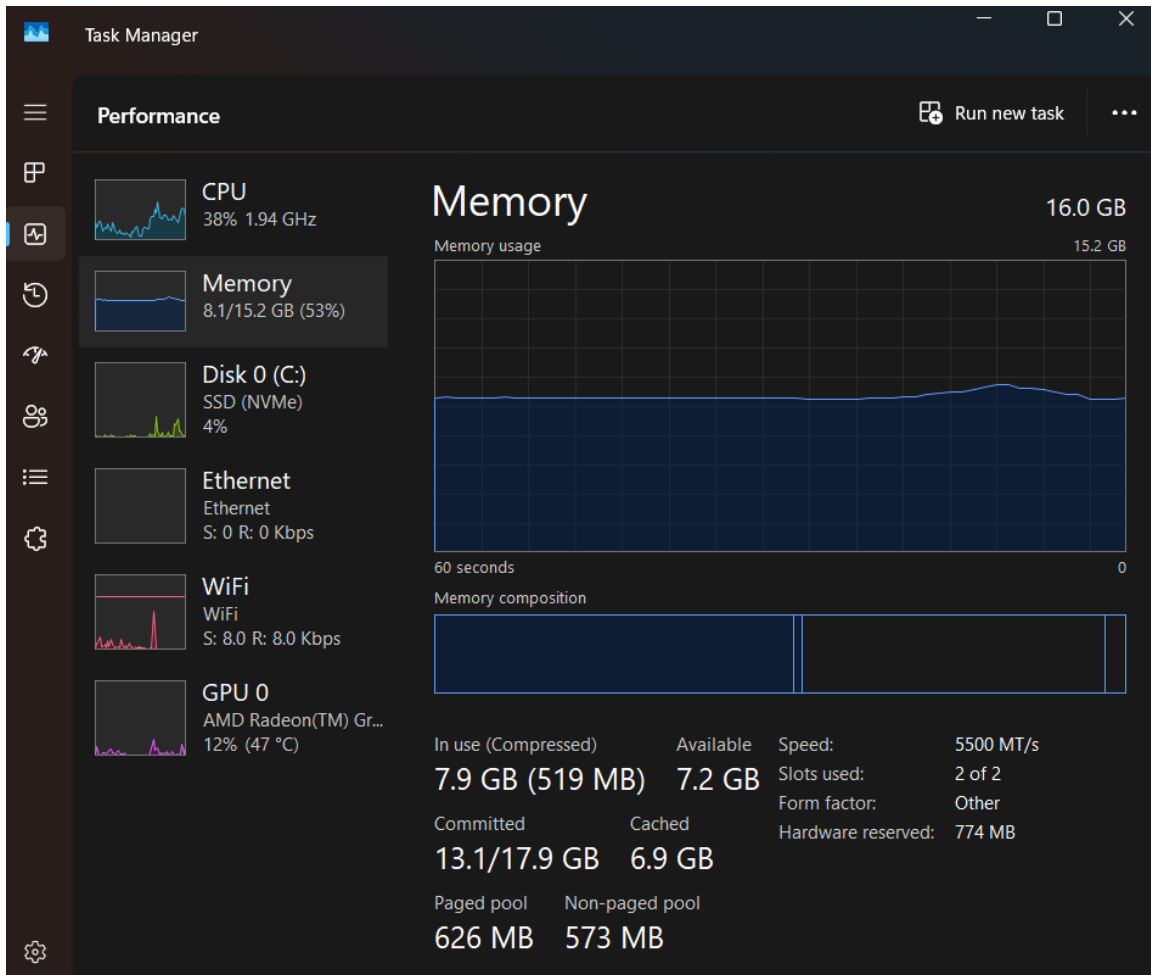
4. Part 3 – Working in the Performance Tab

CPU Overview – Viewing processes and threads.



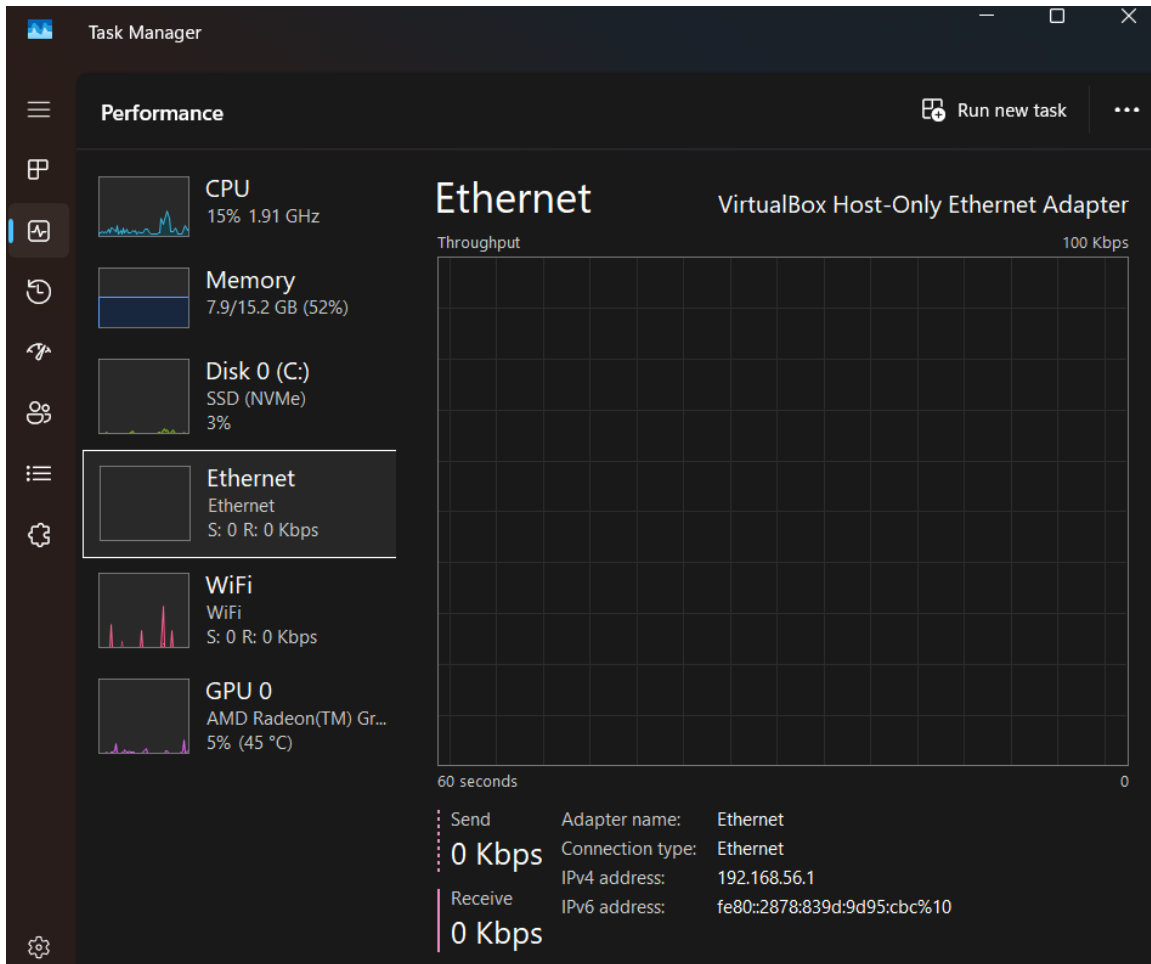
CPU Performance Overview

Memory Analysis – Checking total, available, and used RAM.



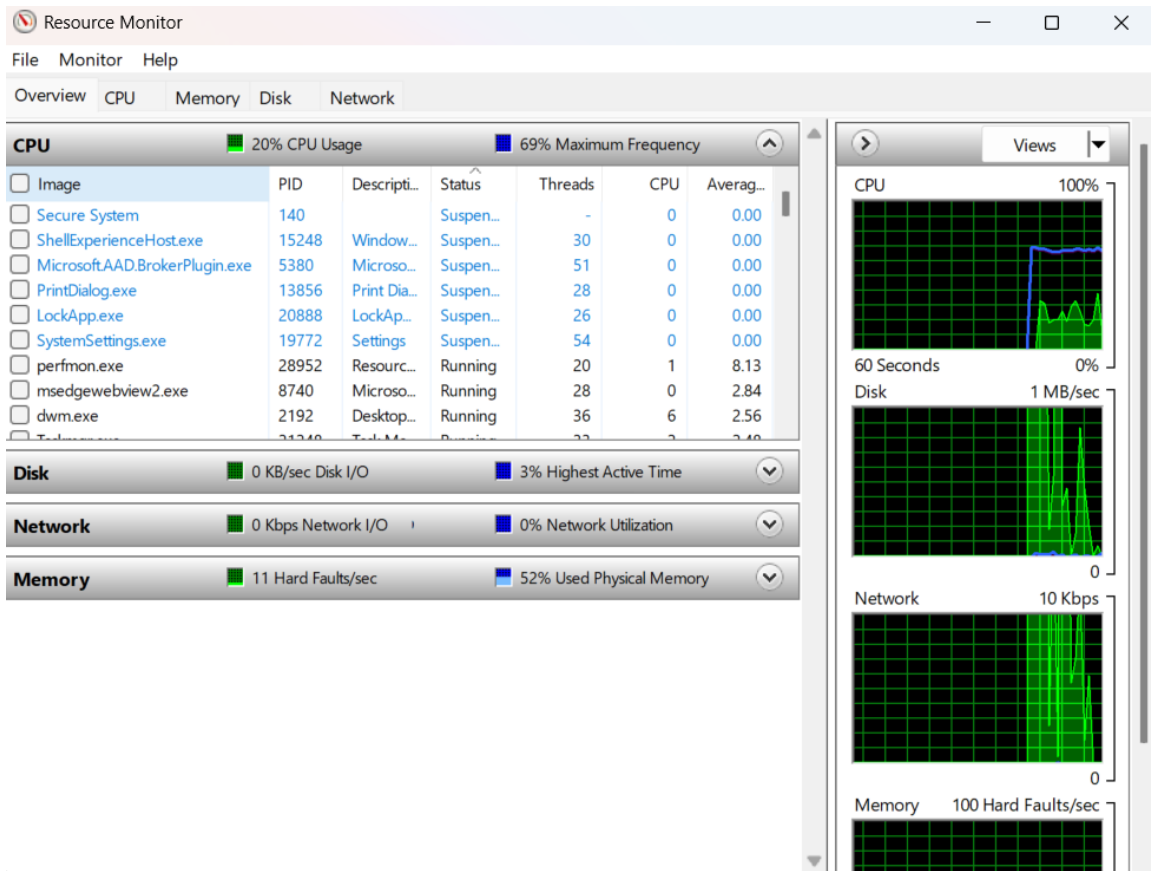
Memory Performance Chart

Ethernet Analysis – Viewing link speed and IPv4 address.



Ethernet Performance Details

Open Resource Monitor for detailed system metrics.



Resource Monitor Window

5. Reflection

Understanding Task Manager is important because it helps administrators monitor performance, identify suspicious processes, manage system resources, and troubleshoot issues. It is a valuable tool in cybersecurity for detecting abnormal activity.